

UNHAPPY: The RSP has finally hit out



SIPRA DAS

Ringling the Division Bell

DELHI The small brother is finally flexing his muscles. On June 1, the Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP), for long at the receiving end of the CPI(M)'s bulldozing ways, took the first salvo by pulling out of the UPA-Left Coordination Committee. "We have come to a

conclusion that providing support to the Government is not conducive. We hope other Left parties would do a rethink on supporting the Government," RSP General Secretary T.J. Chandrachoodan said after a two-day meeting of the party's Central Committee.

The RSP and other smaller parties have been making public demands for the withdrawal of support to the UPA Government, suggesting that the CPI(M) is tailing the Congress, its natural opponent in the Left-ruled states. The CPI(M), in the last meeting of the Left

parties, had insisted that the withdrawal of support at this juncture will ease the BJP's way back to power. With their go-it-alone-style, the junior partners are trying to show cadres back home that they are more sincere than the CPI(M) in opposing the Central Government.

The junior Left partners believe that the Centre is trying to tie their hands by harping on the anti-BJP theme. "Manmohan Singh is worried about our opposition to his economic policies and asks us to be prudent. But he should also reciprocate our feelings against communal forces and be ready to make political compromises by curtailing neo-liberal policies. We should not be taken for granted," says D. Devarajan of the All India Forward Bloc. Though there is no threat to the Government, the embarrassment cannot be papered over.

by Shafi Rahman

THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

The Congress's claim that the defeat in Karnataka was due to its failure to name its chief ministerial candidate is akin to a team losing a cricket match and then blaming it on its inability to find a suitable captain.

VOICES



"Mayawati had sent offers to me to join BSP and threatened that otherwise I will be left doing rounds of courts and made to languish in jail."

Amar Singh, Samajwadi Party general secretary

"The Congress's long-standing claim of being the largest party in the country has weakened. The BJP has emerged as the largest party in the country."

Rajnath Singh, BJP president

"Steady acceleration of growth bears testimony to the wisdom of the saying, slow and steady wins the race. The Indian tortoise will win the race against many Asian hares."

Manmohan Singh, prime minister

"The UPA-Left Coordination Committee was formed for exchange of opinion between the Government and the Left parties. But it has turned into an ineffective and defunct body."

Biman Bose, CPI(M) Politburo member and Left Front chairman

"It is unfortunate. Mayawati is thinking as a chief minister, I am thinking like a mother. There is a big difference between the two."

Renuka Chowdhury, Union minister for women and child development on the Arushi murder case